

The C library `strncmp()` function is used to compare at most a specified number of characters from two null-terminated strings. This string is also known as end of the string i.e. defined through the occurrence of a null character.

Syntax

Following is the syntax of the C library `strncmp()` function

```
strncmp(const char *str1, const char *str2, size_t n)
```

Parameters

This function accepts the following parameters

`str1` This is the first string to be compared.

`str2` This is the second string to be compared.

`n` This parameter refers to maximum number of characters to be compared.

Return Value

This function returns integer value which is

Negative, if the `str1` is less than `str2`.

Positive, if the `str2` is less than `str1`.

zero, if the `str1` is equal to `str2`.

Example 1

Following is the C library `strncmp()` function that checks whether the given two strings are equal or not.

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <string.h>
int main()
{
    char str_1[] = "java";
    char str_2[] = "java";
    if (strncmp(str_1, str_2, strlen(str_2)) == 0)
    {
        printf("The strings '%s' and '%s' are equal.\n", str_1, str_2);
    }
    else
    {
        printf("The strings '%s' and '%s' are not equal.\n", str_1, str_2);
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Output

On execution of above code, we get the following result

The strings 'java' and 'java' are equal.